



**JABATAN PEMBANGUNAN KEMAHIRAN
KEMENTERIAN SUMBER MANUSIA
ARAS 7 & 8 BLOK D4, KOMPLEKS D
PUSAT PENTADBIRAN KERAJAAN PERSEKUTUAN
62502 PUTRAJAYA**

KERTAS PENERANGAN (*INFORMATION SHEET*)

KOD DAN NAMA PROGRAM / <i>PROGRAM'S CODE AND NAME</i>	Z-009-4:2015 CORE ABILITIES	
TAHAP / LEVEL	4 (FOUR)	
NO. DAN TAJUK KEBOLEHAN TERAS / <i>CORE ABILITY NO. AND TITLE</i>	CA04 ETIQUETTE PRACTICES	
NO. DAN PENYATAAN KEBOLEHAN / <i>ABILITY NO. AND STATEMENT</i>	04.01 ADHERE TO CODES OF ETHICAL DISCIPLINE 04.02 COMPLY CULTURAL AWARENESS 04.03 ADHERE TO METICULOUS PERFORMANCE 04.04 ADHERE TO RESULT ORIENTED PRACTICES 04.05 ADHERE PROTOCOL REQUIREMENT	
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TAJUK/ TITLE : CULTURAL AWARENESS

TUJUANI/ PURPOSE :

This Information Sheet is intended to describe about cultural awareness and understanding of how a person's culture may inform their values, behaviour, beliefs and basic assumptions. Cultural awareness recognises that we are all shaped by our cultural background, which influences how we interpret the world around us, perceive ourselves and relate to other people.

PENERANGAN/ INFORMATION :**1. Behaviour Of Cultural Sensitivity**

1.1 When a business hires, it usually depends on a new employee's skills learned from past education or experiences to translate into a position. Unfortunately, past experiences and education do not always teach people how to be culturally sensitive toward one another, and a lack of cultural sensitivity skills among our workforce can have negative consequences.

1.2 Definition

Cultural sensitivity is the awareness and sensitivity of other practices and cultures. Cultural sensitivity skills can include assessing different cultures, how they should be properly approached and how to communicate accordingly. Skills may also include evaluating how certain cultural differences can affect how people work, and how to value differences so that discrimination and harassment, either intended or not, do not occur.

1.3 Importance

Cultural sensitivity skills are important for our employees to function cohesively as a team that is respectful and courteous to each other regardless of cultural differences. Also, cultural sensitivity skills may be important for certain employees who regularly interact with outside business clients, many of whom may have diverse backgrounds and heritages. According to Prime Time Computer Services, Inc. "even one isolated instance of cultural insensitivity can damage the organization."

1.4 Types of Skills

Cultural sensitivity skills can encompass a wide array of abilities, depending on the diversity of your employees and clientele and how culturally sensitive you want employees to be. Typically, though, these skills may include an ability to at least build a functioning professional relationship with others, communicate in a respectful and polite manner according to which culture we are conversing with, and possess an ability to overlook cultural boundaries and interact on a regular basis for the good of

the company. For example, in some cultures it is considered customary to greet one another with a hug. If you are doing business in a culture such as this and you greet your business client with a handshake instead of a hug, your client may be offended.

1.5 Implementation

Providing training to our employees can improve our cultural sensitivity skills at work. Hire a workplace consultant who specializes in teaching cultural sensitivity skills and set aside a certain block of time either in the office or at another location where employees can attend training sessions or workshops and brush up on their skills. Require employees to take a cultural sensitivity test at the end of their training sessions to ensure that they retained the knowledge that was taught to them. Monitor interaction between employees during the work day and note whether our employees' cultural sensitivity skills have improved. If haven't, note what we see and discuss these notes with our workplace consultant.

2. Social Isolation

2.1 Definition

- i) Social isolation refers to a complete or near-complete lack of contact with people and society for members of a social species. It is not the same as loneliness rooted in temporary lack of contact with other humans. Social isolation can be an issue for anyone despite their age, though symptoms may differ by age group.
- ii) Social isolation takes fairly common forms across the spectrum regardless of whether that isolation is self-imposed or is a result of a historical lifelong isolation cycle that has simply never been broken, which also does exist. All types of social isolation can lead to staying home for days or weeks at a time; having no communication with anyone including family or even the most peripheral of acquaintances or friends; and willfully avoiding any contact with other humans when those opportunities do arise. Even when socially isolated people do go out into public and attempt social interactions, the social interactions that succeed, if any are brief and at least somewhat superficial. The feelings of loneliness, fear of others,

or negative self-esteem have the potential to produce very severe psychological injuries

2.2 Effects

- i) True social isolation over years and decades tends to be a chronic condition affecting all aspects of a person's existence. People who are chronically isolated have no one to turn to in personal emergencies, no one to confide in during a crisis, and no one to measure their own behavior against or learn etiquette from — referred to sometimes as social control, but possibly best described as simply being able to see how other people behave and adapt oneself to that behavior.
- ii) Lack of consistent human contact can also cause conflict with the (peripheral) friends the socially isolated person might occasionally talk to, or might cause interaction problems with family members. It may also give rise to uncomfortable thoughts and behaviors within the person.

2.3 The day to day effects of this type of deep-rooted social isolation can mean:

- i) staying home for days or even weeks at a time due to lack of access to social situations rather than a desire to be alone;
- ii) both not contacting, and not being contacted by, any acquaintances, even peripherally; for example, never being called by anybody on the telephone and never having anyone visit one's residence;
- iii) a lack of meaningful, extended relationships, and especially close intimacy (both emotional and physical).[citation needed]

2.4 Social isolation also affects the community, especially when it involves the elderly.

3. Prejudice

3.1 Risk Factors

- i) The following risk factors contribute to reasons why individuals distance themselves from society:
 - a) Health and disabilities - People may be embarrassed by their disabilities or health issues such that they have a tendency to isolate themselves to avoid social interaction out of fear that they would be judged or stigmatized.
 - b) Loss of a spouse - Once a spouse has died, the other person may feel lonely and depressed.
 - c) Living alone
 - d) Unemployment
 - e) Aging - Once a person reaches an age where issues such as cognitive impairments and disabilities arise, they are unable to go out and socialize.
 - f) Transportation issues - If the person doesn't have transportation to attend gatherings or to simply get out of the house, they have no choice but to stay home all day which can lead to those feelings of depression.
 - g) Societal adversity - Desire to avoid the discomfort, dangers, and responsibilities arising from being among people. This can happen if other people are sometimes, or often, rude, hostile, critical or judgmental, crude, or otherwise unpleasant. The person would just prefer to be alone to avoid the hassles and hardships of dealing with people.

3.2 The key considerations towards cultural awareness :

- i) Be aware of your own cultural influences.
- ii) Be aware of judging other people's behaviour and beliefs according to the standards of your own culture.

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- iii) Be aware of making assumptions about cultural influences and applying generalisations to individuals.
- iv) Understand that the behaviour and beliefs of people within each culture can vary considerably.
- v) Understand that the extent to which people adopt practices of their new country and retain those from their cultural background can vary within communities, even within families.
- vi) Understand that not all people identify with their cultural or religious background.
- vii) Understand that culture itself is a fluid entity, undergoing transformations as a result of globalisation, migration and the diaspora influence.
- viii) Increase your knowledge about different cultural practices and issues through cultural background information sessions and/or resources and cultural awareness training.
- ix) Understand the importance of appropriate communication.

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SOALANI/ QUESTIONS :

1. What is the definition of cultural sensitivity?
2. How do we want to ensure that every employees really understood of a cultural sensitivity?
3. What is the definition of social isolation?

RUJUKANI/ REFERENCE :

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